

## Skills Summary

### Picking an Addition Strategy

*Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.*

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#### Skill 1 — Count On (small second number)

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**When to use it:** one of the numbers is little (1, 2 or 3).

**Rule:** say the **bigger** number, then hop the little one.

**Example:**  $7 + 2$

**Step 1.** The 2 is small, so counting on from the bigger number is the quick tool here.

**Step 2.** Say 7, hop 8, 9 — two hops for the 2. ✓

$$\Rightarrow 7 + 2 = 9$$

**Try it:**  $1 + 8$  (start big!)

check: 6

#### Skill 2 — Doubles and Near Doubles

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**When to use it:** the numbers match, or almost match.

**Rule:** know the doubles by heart ( $2 + 2$ ,  $3 + 3$ ,  $4 + 4$ ,  $5 + 5$ ); for neighbors, use the double and one more.

**Example:**  $2 + 3$

**Step 1.** 2 and 3 are neighbors, so we use the double of the smaller number and one more.

**Step 2.**  $2 + 2 = 4$ , and one more makes 5. ✓

$$\Rightarrow 2 + 3 = 5$$

**Try it:**  $4 + 5$  (use  $4 + 4$  and one more)

check: 6

#### Skill 3 — Tens Partners

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**When to use it:** the two numbers fit together to make ten.

**Rule:** know the partner pairs — 1 and 9, 2 and 8, 3 and 7, 4 and 6, 5 and 5 — and answer 10 right away.

**Example:**  $8 + 2$

**Step 1.** 8 and 2 are a partner pair, so no counting is needed — partners always make ten.

**Step 2.**  $8 + 2$  fills the ten-frame exactly. ✓

$$\Rightarrow 8 + 2 = 10$$

**Try it:**  $9 + 1$

check: 10

**(!) Watch out:** Counting on works for everything — but it is slow for big second numbers. If you catch yourself hopping 7 times, look again: a double or a tens partner was probably hiding there!